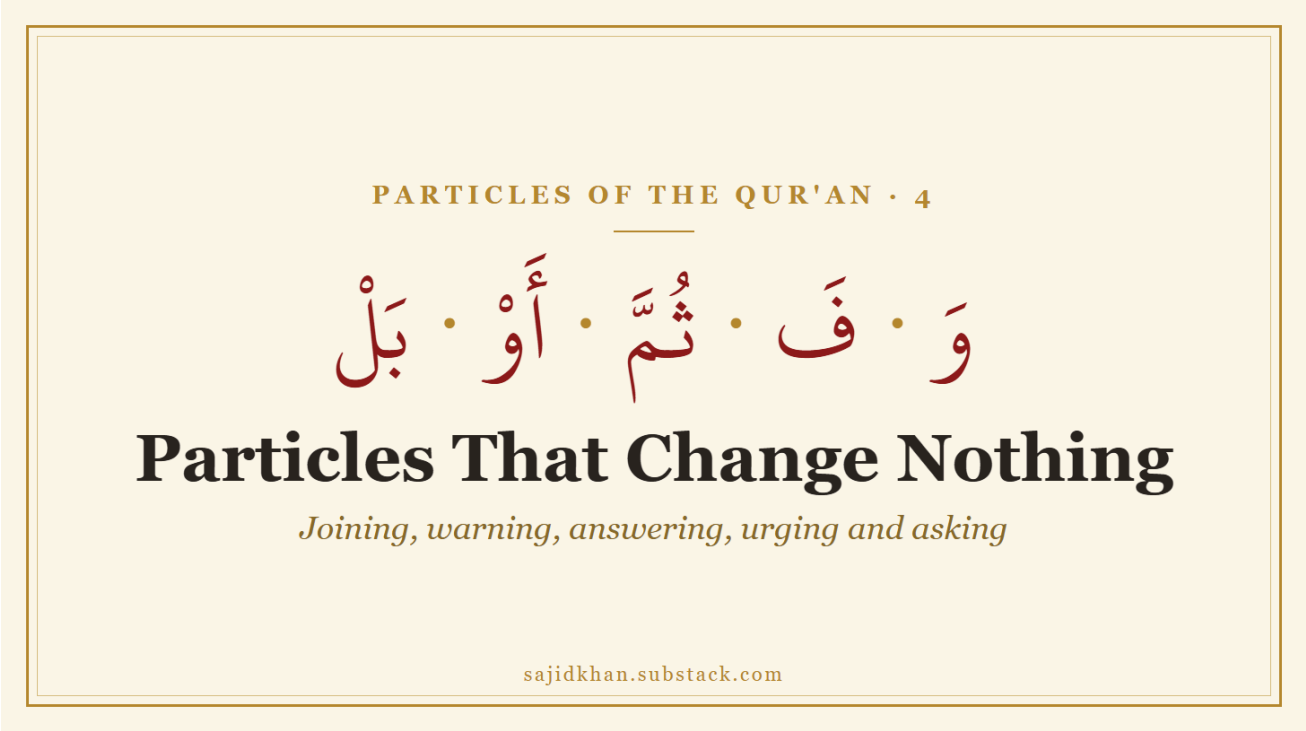


PARTICLES OF THE QUR'AN

Particles of the Qur'an 4: Particles That Change Nothing

Joining, warning, answering, urging and asking

Particles of the Qur'an, part 4 of 5

The particles in this part are "inactive" (*ghayr 'aamilah*, غَيْرُ عَامِلَة, "not working"): they add meaning but do not change the ending of the word after them.

Joining words: the conjunctions

The particles of joining (*huroof al-'atf*, حُرُوفُ الْعَطْفِ): وَ "and", فَ "and so", ثُمَّ "then, after that", حَتَّى "even", أَوْ "or", إِمَّا "either … or", أَمْ "or (in a question)", لَا "not", بَلْ "rather, no", لَـٰكِنْ "but". A word joined by one of these copies the case of the word it is joined to (the conjunction itself changes nothing). Each will get its own post later.

Getting attention

- **Here you are:** هَا أَنتُمْ هَـٰؤُلَاءِ حَاجَجْتُمْ .هَا "Here you are, those who argued" (3:66).

- **Beware, truly:** أَلَا . أَلَا سَاءَ مَا يَزِرُونَ "Beware! Evil is what they carry" (6:31).
- **Not to be confused with:** أَمَّا "as for", which brings out details and is followed by فَ: فَأَمَّا مَن ثَقُلَتْ مَوَازِينُهُ "then as for the one whose scales are heavy" (101:6).

Saying "yes"

- **Yes, by...:** إِى, always with an oath. قُلْ إِى وَرَبِّي إِنَّهُ لَحَقٌّ "Say: yes, by my Lord, it is the truth" (10:53).
- **Yes indeed (after a negative question):** ... بَلَىٰ. أَوَلَيْسَ الَّذِى خَلَقَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ بِقَادِرٍ بَلَىٰ "Is not He who created the heavens and the earth able...? Yes indeed!" (36:81).
- **Yes:** نَعَمْ. قَالَ نَعَمْ وَإِنَّكُمْ لَمِنَ الْمُقَرَّبِينَ "He said: Yes, and you will be among those brought near" (7:114).

Explaining

The particles of explanation are أَىْ "that is" and أَنْ "that is, namely".

Urging: "why not?"

The most common is لَوْلَا "why not", and a verb follows it. فَلَوْلَا إِذَا بَلَغَتِ الْحُلْقُومَ "Then why not, when the soul reaches the throat..." (56:83).

Certainty: قَدْ

The particle قَدْ (*qad*) has two uses before a past verb:

- **Certainly:** it makes the statement sure (*harf tahqeeq*, حَرْف تَحْقِيق). قَدْ أَفْلَحَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ "Certainly the believers have succeeded" (23:1).
- **Just now:** it brings the past close (*maadee qareeb*, مَاضِى قَرِيب, "near past"). قَدْ قَامَتِ الصَّلَاةُ "the prayer has (just) begun" (from the iqamah).

Asking questions

- **What:** مَا. وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا هِيَهْ "And what will make you know what it is?" (101:10).
- **Do...? (the hamza):** أَ. أَأَمِنتُم مَّن فِى السَّمَاءِ "Do you feel safe from the One in the heaven?" (67:16).

- **Has…? Did…?:** هَلْ. وَهَلْ أَتَاكَ حَدِيثُ مُوسَىٰ "And has the story of Moses reached you?" (20:9).

Next: كَلَّا, the two kinds of ت, tanween, and the ن of emphasis.

From my book Quran Grammar Summary *(second edition), section 1.5.*

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